



October 15th 2018 Delaware County Commissioners Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ifG596kfS8Y
Publication Date	2018-10-15T22:12:27Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer, Mr. Henry.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Henry (President)
 - **Board Members Present:** Ms. Ravier (also referred to in roll calls as Ms. Ravier / Ms. Brady / Ms. Regan) and Mr. King (also referred to as Mr. Pembroke). (*Note: Transcript captures varying phonetic transcriptions of member names during roll calls*).
 - **Staff Present:** John Brooke (Attorney), Jason Walker, and Jason Rogers.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Approval of Minutes:** **00:00:40** The board moved to approve the minutes from the October 1st, 2018 meeting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call vote conducted: Mr. Henry - Yes, Ms. Ravier - Yes, Mr. King - Yes).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:00:56 2019 Holiday Schedule**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented by board leadership.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed the schedule, noting it remains largely the same as previous years with standard federal holidays.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:01:35 Mid-Met Bill Corporation Billing Service Agreement (EMS Billing)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jason Walker
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Jason Walker presented the contract renewal for EMS billing services. Negotiations resulted in a 4% price increase from what the vendor originally requested, which staff and Attorney John Brooke reviewed and found acceptable with no major issues.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:02:37 IT Services Contract Upgrade Options**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board leadership / Attorney John Brooke
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed proposed IT upgrades and a contract structure from Structured Point. Attorney John Brooke reviewed the contract and found no issues. The agreement outlines phased payments with no strict obligation to execute every phase immediately, allowing the commissioners flexibility based on timing and need. Some minor upgrades have already been coordinated with Mr. Fluke.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and seconded to table the item for further personal review by board members. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote.
- **00:04:27 Vehicle Surplus Transfer to Gaston Fire Department**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jason Rogers
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Jason Rogers reported on vehicle surplus status and checks received. A request was received from Gaston for assistance, prompting a proposal to transfer a surplus vehicle specifically a 2007 K1500 Chevy to the Gaston Fire Department to be utilized as a first responder vehicle.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:05:53 Delaware County Veterans Stand Down Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nate (Veterans Affairs / County Office)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented a report on the Delaware County Veterans Stand Down event. Key metrics and achievements included serving 143 veterans (the

largest turnout recorded), hosting 53 vendors (including employers, community services, and educational institutions like Ivy Tech and Ball State), serving over 400 meals, helping three officially homeless veterans secure housing within a week, and facilitating three full-time job placements. Invoices are currently being processed through the donation account. Appreciation was expressed to numerous community donors, organizations, and the Care Board for providing the venue. Additionally, an invitation was extended to veterans to join the county float in the upcoming Muncie Central homecoming parade.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal board action required.
- **00:09:21 Discussion & Administrative Report on County Jail Project Due Diligence**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Henry / Attorney John Brooke
 - **Deliberation Summary:** In response to public and political discussions regarding the jail project, the board asked Attorney John Brooke to provide a comprehensive historical review of the due diligence performed by the commissioners.
 - Mr. Brooke outlined past options explored since late 2017:
 1. *Industrial Center Shell Building (Gar Him / Gar Long proposal):* Estimated at \$60-\$70 million for renovation (potentially over \$100 million if incorporating courts), requiring long-distance prisoner transportation and increased operational/manpower costs. Furthermore, economic development grant rules would restrict contractors.
 2. *Retrofitting the Current Justice Center:* Involved a 15,000+ square foot addition and vertical expansion, but faced strict building code hurdles, prohibitive costs, and the massive expense of housing prisoners elsewhere for 2-3 years during construction.
 3. *Ground-Up ("Green Earth") Facility:* Estimated at roughly \$80 million, requiring a bond issue and a new tax increase (income tax or property tax), alongside severe infrastructure obstacles regarding electrical capacity and wastewater (Liberty Regional Services).
 4. *Ainsworth Building Option:* Estimated around \$45 million, capable of being funded through EDIT (Economic Development Income Tax) funds without imposing a new tax burden on citizens.
 - The board emphasized that an ordinance was passed in June to avoid wasting \$150,000 of taxpayer money on a redundant study. Commissioners defended their comprehensive approach, noting that their responsibilities also span extensive county road paving and infrastructure improvements over the last four years. They cautioned against politically motivated criticisms from former sheriffs relying on outdated information.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None during this agenda item.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational review and report entry; no formal vote taken.
 - **00:21:59 Payment of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board leadership
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of claims totaling \$1,150,780.45.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:22:13** Presiding officer asked if any members of the public had comments. No members of the public stepped forward to speak.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** None stated beyond ongoing report generation.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to recess/adjourn approved by voice vote. Time not explicitly stated in transcript.
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